

FROM CIVIC LEARNING TO CIVIC POWER

*A statewide K-12 civic education
initiative building the infrastructure that
makes equitable civic participation the
default condition in Delaware, not the
exception.*

4 STRATEGIC FRONTS

6 PRIORITY COMMUNITIES

5 COMPARISON STATES

PILOT YEAR 2025

// THE PROBLEM

THE GAP BETWEEN KNOWING AND DOING

Delaware's 2018 Civics Standards carry no statutory mandate, no dedicated funding, and no accountability structure tied to LEA implementation. The result: access to quality civic education depends on which district a student attends. Students in under-resourced schools, disproportionately immigrant, Black, Brown, and multilingual, receive the least.

CIRCLE's 2025 research confirms the civic engagement gap is a supply-side failure. Young people want to participate. The system is not built to support them.

"The barrier to youth civic participation is not motivation. It is access, safety, and structured invitation."

CIRCLE, 2025

// THE STATISTICS

THE NUMBERS

<25%

8TH GRADERS PROFICIENT IN CIVICS NATIONALLY

\$1,100

PER MULTILINGUAL LEARNER IN DE VS. \$6-9K NEIGHBORING STATES

2X+

MORE YOUTH WOULD ENGAGE IF GIVEN STRUCTURED OPPORTUNITY

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STATES WITH STRATEGIC NONVIOLENCE IN CIVIC STATUTE

FOUR STRATEGIC FRONTS

- 01

Statewide Policy + LEA Implementation
Statutory mandate, equity-disaggregated reporting, dedicated funding tied to multilingual and community partnership requirements.
- 02

Community-Rooted Power Building
Parent and student leadership labs, youth organizing pathways, and community accountability structures with real authority.
- 03

School-Based Partnerships + Hands-On Practice
Action civics connected to real decisions: participatory budgeting, policy simulations, direct decision-maker engagement.
- 04

Strategic Nonviolence + Leadership Development
The differentiating argument. No comparison state has codified this. Delaware can go first.

SIX-SESSION ARC

A structured program bringing action civics, strategic nonviolence, and community-rooted power building to Delaware schools and community organizations. 3-5 pilot sites in Year 1, one per county, with an evaluation framework designed to generate the evidence base for statewide expansion.

01 LEARN	Grounding Civic Knowledge in Reality Community listening, real policy documents, power mapping begins.
02 ANALYZE	Power Mapping with a Community Partner Full stakeholder analysis with a real community partner attending and responding.
03 ORGANIZE	Nonviolence as Organizing Strategy Kingian Nonviolence Six Steps applied to the cohort's issue. De-escalation practice.
04 ORG+ACT	Strategy and Campaign Design Full campaign strategy, theory of change, civic leverage concept.
05 ACT	Real Civic Action School board, council, policy recommendation. Institution required to respond.
06 REFLECT	Teach Back + Reflect 30-min teach-back to new audience. Full honest debrief. Pipeline opt-in.

LEADERSHIP PIPELINE

// BUILT TO BECOME SELF-SUSTAINING

- 01

Participant

Complete the arc. Leave as a civic multiplier with documented action experience.
- 02

Observer-Analyst

Co-facilitate future cohorts. Reduces per-cohort external staffing cost.
- 03

Lead Facilitator

20-30 hour practicum. Run cohorts independently. Statewide scalability node.

// COMMUNITY PARTNERS

PRIORITY COMMUNITIES + PARTNERS

Six communities identified by documented gaps in civic access. Inclusion is a design requirement, not a program consideration.

Immigrant + Mixed-Status Families La Esperanza, LACC	Black and Brown Youth Kingian grounding, student issue selection
Hispanic + Latino Communities Spanish materials, bilingual facilitation	Disabled Students + Families UDL standard, disability justice curriculum
LGBTQIA+ Youth Equality Delaware, PRIDE Council, I Am Me Inc.	Multilingual Families English + Spanish minimum, interpretation standard

PARTNER WITH US

We are seeking pilot partner schools, community organizations, and funders for Year 1. We start with a listening conversation, not a pitch. Three ways to get involved: pilot partner school, community partner, or infrastructure funder.

civicpower.networkdelaware.org/pilot.html